

SS3 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: DRAWING AND PAINTING

1.1 INTRODUCTION: THE FOUNDATION OF ART

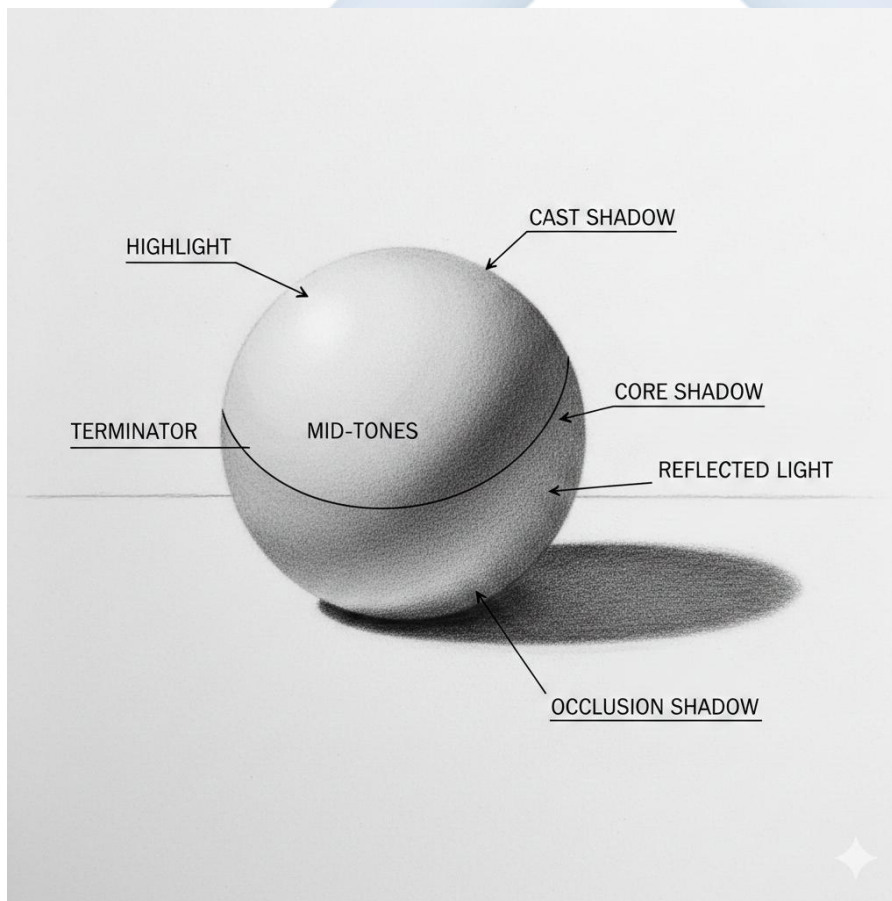
Drawing and Painting are the foundational pillars of visual arts.

- **Drawing** is the process of creating an image on a surface (like paper) by making lines, marks, and shapes. It is often (but not always) monochromatic and is primarily concerned with form, line, and value (light/dark).
- **Painting** is the practice of applying pigment (colour) suspended in a medium (like oil or water) to a surface (like canvas). It is primarily concerned with colour, tone, and texture.



1.2 MATERIALS AND TOOLS FOR DRAWING

1. **Pencils:** Graded from 9H (very hard, light line) to 9B (very soft, dark line). HB is standard. H-grades are for technical drawing, B-grades are for artistic shading.
2. **Charcoal:** (Vine or Compressed): Creates deep, rich blacks. Excellent for large, expressive drawings and shading.
3. **Pastels:** (Chalk or Oil): Sticks of pure pigment. Allow for painting-like effects.
4. **Pen and Ink:** Provides strong, permanent lines. Used for hatching and cross-hatching.
5. **Erasers:** (Kneaded, Gum, Vinyl): Used for correcting, but also as a "drawing tool" to lift pigment and create highlights.
6. **Stumps & Tortillons:** Rolled paper tools used for blending and smudging graphite or charcoal.
7. **Surface (Support):** Drawing paper, cartridge paper, newsprint, toned paper.



1.3 MATERIALS AND TOOLS FOR PAINTING

1. Pigments & Medium:

- **Watercolour:** Transparent. Pigment in a water-soluble binder.
 - **Oils:** Pigment in drying oil (e.g., linseed oil). Slow-drying, allows for rich blending.
 - **Acrylics:** Pigment in an acrylic polymer emulsion. Fast-drying, versatile, water-soluble when wet, waterproof when dry.
 - **Gouache:** Opaque watercolour.
2. **Brushes:** Come in various shapes (Flat, Round, Filbert, Fan) and materials (Sable, synthetic). Different brushes create different marks.
 3. **Support (Surface):** Canvas (stretched or board), wood panels, watercolour paper.
 4. **Palette:** A flat surface (wood, plastic, or glass) used for mixing paints.
 5. **Palette Knife:** Used for mixing paint, and can also be used to apply paint (impasto).
 6. **Easel:** A stand used to hold the canvas upright.
 7. **Mediums:** Liquids (like linseed oil for oils, or water for acrylics) used to thin paint or change its properties (e.g., flow, drying time).
 8. **Varnish:** A final protective layer applied to a finished (and dry) oil or acrylic painting.

1.4 OBSERVATION: THE KEY TO REALISM

- **Observation** is the skill of "seeing" as an artist, not just "looking." It involves analyzing:
 - **Form:** The 3D shape of an object.
 - **Value (Light/Shadow):** Where the light hits (highlight) and where it doesn't (shadow, core shadow, reflected light). This is what creates the illusion of 3D form.
 - **Proportion:** The size and scale of one part of an object relative to another.
 - **Texture:** The surface quality of the object (rough, smooth, shiny, fuzzy).
 - **Negative Space:** The empty space *around* and *between* objects. Drawing the negative space can help you accurately place the positive space (the object itself).

1.5 NATURE COMPOSITION DRAWING

- **Nature Composition** involves drawing or painting natural objects (e.g., fruits, flowers, leaves, shells, skulls, landscapes).
- **Composition:** The *arrangement* of these objects on the page. Good composition is balanced, has a clear focal point, and leads the viewer's eye through the artwork.
- **Applying Colour to Natural Objects:**
 - **Local Colour:** The "true" colour of the object (e.g., a lemon is yellow).
 - **Observed Colour:** The colour as it is actually seen. The "yellow" lemon will have highlights (white, light yellow), mid-tones (yellow), and shadows (dark yellow, brown, or even purple, as it reflects the shadow colour).
 - **Colour Theory:** Use knowledge of **complementary colours** (e.g., red/green) to make objects "pop" or to create more natural shadows.

EVALUATION

1. Differentiate between Drawing and Painting.
2. List three drawing tools and three painting tools, explaining their specific functions.
3. What is "Negative Space," and why is it important in drawing?
4. Explain the difference between "Local Colour" and "Observed Colour."

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. Set up a simple nature composition (e.g., a piece of fruit, a leaf, and a cup).
2. Create a detailed pencil drawing, paying close attention to highlights, core shadows, and cast shadows to show form.
3. Create a full-colour painting (watercolour or acrylic) of the same composition. Focus on blending colours to show the *observed* colour, not just the *local* colour.

WEEK 2: HISTORY OF ART (WESTERN ART)

2.1 INTRODUCTION

Western Art history traces the development of visual art in Europe and regions that share its culture. This week, we examine the art produced after the fall of Rome, which was dominated by religion.

2.2 EARLY CHRISTIAN ART (c. 200–500 AD)

- **Context:** Before Christianity was legalized (313 AD), art was secret, found in the **catacombs** (underground tombs) of Rome.
- **Focus:** Art was for **storytelling** (salvation, miracles) and **symbolism**, not realism.
 - **Symbols:** Fish (Christ), Shepherd (Christ and his flock), Chi-Rho (monogram of Christ).
- **Characteristics:** Simple, flat, 2D figures. The *message* was more important than the *beauty*.
- **Media:** **Frescoes** (painting on wet plaster) on catacomb walls.
- **Architecture:** After 313 AD, Christians adopted the Roman **Basilica** (a long hall) as the model for their churches.



2.3 BYZANTINE ART (c. 500–1453 AD)

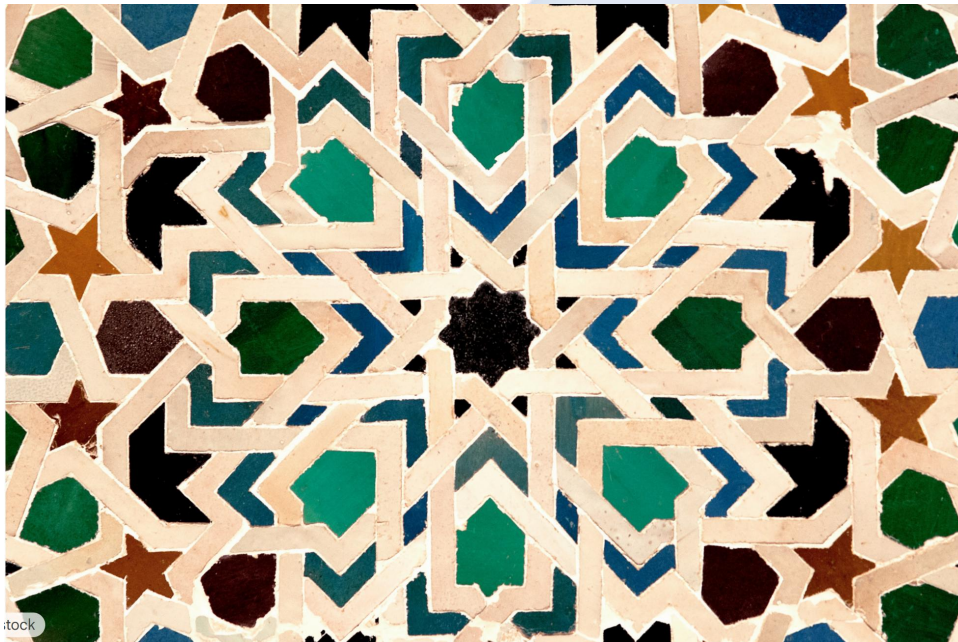
- **Context:** The Eastern Roman Empire, with its capital at **Constantinople** (Byzantium).
- **Focus:** Deeply religious and formal. Art was a "window" to the divine, not a picture of the real world.
- **Characteristics:**
 - **Icons:** Stylized, formal portraits of Christ, Mary, and Saints.
 - **Gold Backgrounds:** Symbolized the divine, heavenly realm.
 - **Elongated Figures:** Flat, "floating" figures with no sense of weight or body.
 - **Not Realistic:** Realism was seen as pagan (Greek/Roman).
- **Media:** **Mosaics** (images made from tiny pieces of coloured glass or tile) and **egg tempera** (pigment mixed with egg yolk) on wooden panels for icons.
- **Architecture:** The **Hagia Sophia** in Constantinople. Its key innovation was the **pendentive**, which allowed a massive circular dome to sit on a square base.



2.4 ISLAMIC ART (c. 7th Century Onwards)

- **Context:** Spread rapidly from the Middle East, across North Africa (influencing Nigeria) and into Spain.
- **Focus:** Religious art is **Aniconic** (avoids depicting human or animal figures, as this is seen as competing with God's act of creation).

- **Key Characteristics:**
 1. **Geometric Patterns:** Complex, repeating, interlocking patterns that represent the infinite nature of Allah.
 2. **Calligraphy:** The use of beautiful Arabic script (often from the Qur'an) as the *central* art form.
 3. **Arabesque:** Stylized, flowing, "scrolling" patterns of leaves and vines.
- **Media:** **Tilework** (mosaics), carpets, metalwork, illustrated manuscripts (for non-religious subjects).
- **Architecture:** The **Mosque**, characterized by minarets, domes, and courtyards.



2.5 RENAISSANCE ART (c. 1400–1600 AD)

- **Context:** A "Rebirth" of classical Greek and Roman ideals, art, and learning, starting in Florence, Italy.
- **Key Idea: Humanism** - A shift in focus from a purely divine world to the achievements and potential of human beings.
- **Characteristics (A REVOLUTION):**
 1. **Realism & Anatomical Correctness:** Artists studied human anatomy.

2. **Linear Perspective:** A mathematical system (invented by Brunelleschi) to create the *illusion* of 3D depth on a 2D surface.
 3. **Chiaroscuro:** The dramatic use of light and shadow (light/dark) to model 3D forms.
 4. **Patronage:** Art was commissioned by wealthy families (like the Medici) and the Pope, not just the Church.
- **Artists:**
 - **Early Renaissance:** Masaccio (perspective), Donatello (realist sculpture, *David*).
 - **High Renaissance (The "Giants"):**
 - **Leonardo da Vinci:** *Mona Lisa*, *The Last Supper*. The ultimate "Renaissance Man" (scientist, inventor, artist).
 - **Michelangelo:** *David* (sculpture), *Pieta*, the **Sistine Chapel ceiling** (fresco).
 - **Raphael:** *The School of Athens* (a perfect blend of classical and Christian ideals).
 - **Media:** Oil on canvas (a new, flexible medium), Fresco, Tempera, Marble (sculpture).

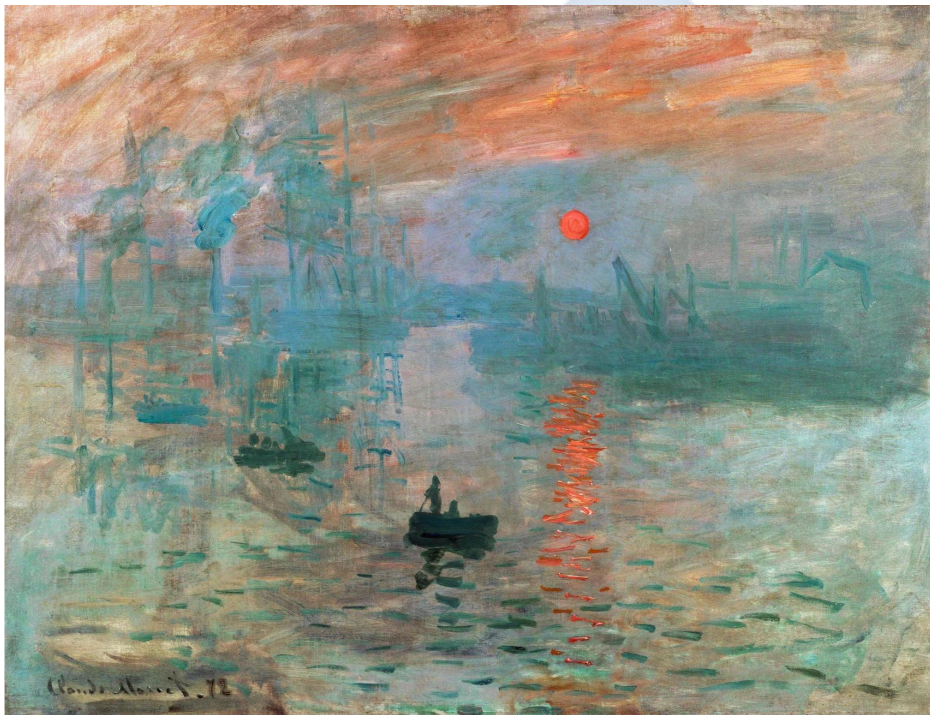
EVALUATION

1. Why was early Christian art symbolic and not realistic?
2. What is an "icon," and what art period is it from? Name two characteristics of Byzantine art.
3. Islamic art is "aniconic." What are the three main decorative elements it uses instead?
4. What was "Humanism," and how did it change the subject of Renaissance art?
5. List the three "giants" of the High Renaissance and one masterpiece for each.

WEEK 3: IMPRESSIONISM ART MOVEMENT

3.1 INTRODUCTION (THE "REVOLUTION")

- **Impressionism** was a 19th-century art movement (c. 1870s-1880s) based in Paris. It is often considered the *first* truly "modern" art movement.
- The name was originally an insult. A critic, Louis Leroy, mocked **Claude Monet's** painting *Impression, Sunrise* (1872) as just a "sketch" or an "impression," not a finished painting. The artists adopted the name with pride.



3.2 CONTEXT: REBELLING AGAINST THE "SALON"

- The "**Salon**" was the official, government-sponsored art exhibition in Paris.
- It celebrated **Academic Art**: Traditional, "finished," polished paintings of historical, religious, or mythological scenes.
- The Impressionists were "rebels" who were rejected by the Salon. They held their own independent exhibitions.
- **Two Inventions**: Their style was made possible by:

1. **Pre-packaged Paint Tubes:** Artists could now leave the studio and paint outdoors.
2. **Photography:** Photography could capture a realistic "copy" of the world perfectly. This "freed" painters to do what photography *couldn't*—capture subjective, fleeting moments of light and colour.



3.3 CHARACTERISTICS AND STYLE

The core idea was to capture the *fleeting, sensory impression* of a moment, especially the effect of **light**.

1. **Painting *En Plein Air*:** (French for "in the open air"). They painted outdoors, directly observing their subject.
2. **Visible, Short Brushstrokes:** They did *not* blend their colours smoothly. They used thick, quick, visible strokes to show the texture of the paint and the speed of the moment.

3. **Focus on Light:** Their *real* subject was often the *light itself* and how it changed the appearance of objects (e.g., Monet painted the same cathedral 30 times at different times of day).
4. **Ordinary Subject Matter:** They rejected "grand" subjects and instead painted everyday life: landscapes, cityscapes, cafés, dance halls, and domestic scenes.
5. **Bright, Unblended Colours:** They applied pure, bright colours directly to the canvas, often side-by-side, letting the viewer's eye "mix" them from a distance. (e.g., blue and yellow strokes next to each other "mix" to look green).

3.4 ARTISTS INVOLVED (EXPONENTS)

1. **Claude Monet:** The "leader." Famous for *Impression*, *Sunrise*, his water lilies, and haystacks.
2. **Edgar Degas:** Famous for painting ballet dancers and racehorses, known for his unusual, "snapshot-like" compositions.
3. **Pierre-Auguste Renoir:** Famous for painting joyful social scenes, with dappled light filtering through trees on people (*Luncheon of the Boating Party*).
4. **Camille Pissarro:** A key organizer and mentor. Painted rural and urban landscapes.
5. **Berthe Morisot & Mary Cassatt:** Leading female Impressionists who brought a unique, often domestic, perspective to the movement.

3.5 FUNCTIONS AND INFLUENCE

- **Functions:** To capture the reality of *modern life* as it was lived; to explore the science of optics and how we *see*; to break free from the "dead" rules of the Academy.
- **Influence:** Impressionism "broke" the rules of art, paving the way for all of modern art. It directly led to Post-Impressionism (Van Gogh, Cézanne) and, eventually, to total abstraction.

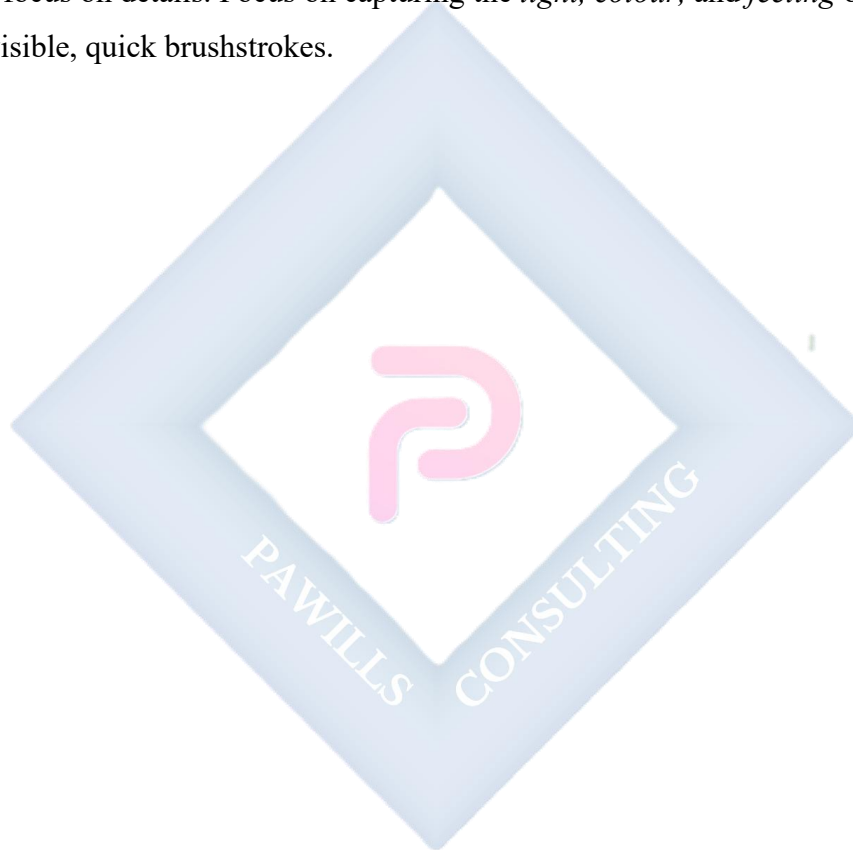
EVALUATION

1. What is the origin of the name "Impressionism"?
2. What does it mean to paint "*en plein air*," and what invention made it possible?

3. List three main characteristics of the Impressionist style.
4. Name three key Impressionist artists and their typical subject matter.
5. How did the invention of photography influence the Impressionists?

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. Find a window in your home or go outside.
2. Using paints or pastels, try to paint a quick "impression" of the scene (10-15 minutes).
3. Do not focus on details. Focus on capturing the *light, colour, and feeling* of the moment using visible, quick brushstrokes.



WEEK 4: NIGERIAN CONTEMPORARY ARTISTS

4.1 INTRODUCTION: THE BIRTH OF MODERN NIGERIAN ART

Contemporary (Modern) Nigerian Art refers to the art produced in Nigeria from the 20th century onwards. It is *not* traditional, "tribal" art. Its history is the story of Nigerian artists blending their deep cultural heritage with Western techniques to create a new, unique, modern identity.

4.2 THE PIONEER: AINA ONABOLU (1882–1963)

- **History:** Onabolu is the "Father of Modern Nigerian Art." He was a self-taught artist who, in the early 1900s, was determined to master the Western academic style of realism.
- **Contribution:** The colonial government believed Africans were incapable of realistic art. Onabolu went to London, trained at St. John's Wood Art School, and returned as a master portraitist.
- **Area of Specialization: Realism / Portraiture.**
- **Legacy:** He *proved* that Africans could master Western art, and he single-handedly fought to have art included in the Nigerian colonial school curriculum.

4.3 THE FIRST INTERNATIONAL STAR: BEN ENWONWU (1917–1994)

- **History:** A student of Onabolu's, Enwonwu became the first Nigerian artist to gain international fame.
- **Contribution:** He was a brilliant painter and sculptor. His painting *Tutu* (a portrait of an Ife princess, the "African Mona Lisa") became a national symbol.
- **Area of Specialization: Sculpture and Painting.** He blended European techniques with African themes, particularly the dynamic, "dancing" forms inspired by Igbo spirits (*agbogho mmuo*).
- **Legacy:** He was an "ambassador" for Nigerian art, proving its vitality to the world.



4.4 THE ZARIA ART SOCIETY ("ZARIA REBELS")

- **History:** A group of art students at the Nigerian College of Arts, Science and Technology (now ABU, Zaria) in the late 1950s.
- **The Problem:** They were being taught a purely Western art curriculum by their British lecturers.
- **Their Solution: "Natural Synthesis."** This was their philosophy. They decided to *synthesize* (combine) Western techniques (like oil painting, printmaking) with the forms, myths, aesthetics, and traditions of their *own* African cultures (Igbo *Uli* designs, Yoruba carvings, etc.).



- **Key Artists and their Specializations:**

1. **UCHE OKEKE:** A leader of the group.

- **Contribution:** Pioneered the "Uli" style, adapting the fluid, elegant lines of Igbo body and wall painting into his modern art.
- **Legacy:** Founded the "Nsukka School" (at UNN), a major art movement.

2. **BRUCE ONOBRAKPEYA:**

- **Contribution:** A master printmaker. He *invented* new printmaking techniques like "Plastograph" (using araldite on a board) to create deeply textured, intricate prints.
- **Area of Specialization: Printmaking.** His work is full of Urhobo mythology and folklore.

3. **DEMAS NWOKO:**

- **Contribution:** A painter, sculptor, and architect. He blended Nok terracotta forms with modern abstraction.
- **Area of Specialization: Painting, Sculpture.**

4. **YUSUF GRILLO:**

- **Contribution:** Though a member, his style was different. He used geometric forms and a famous "cool blue" colour palette to create lyrical, elongated figures, often based on Yoruba themes.
- **Area of Specialization: Painting.**

4.5 THE "GRAND DAME": LADI KWALI (1925–1984)

- **History:** She was a traditional Gwari potter from Northern Nigeria.
- **Contribution:** In the 1950s, the British potter Michael Cardew recognized her genius and invited her to work at his new pottery training centre in Abuja.
- **Area of Specialization: Ceramics.** She blended her traditional Gwari techniques (coiling, incising) with Western ceramic techniques (glazing, wheel-throwing) to create world-famous, unique pottery.

- **Legacy:** She broke barriers as a female artist and became a global symbol of Nigerian art (she is the woman on the Nigerian 20 Naira note).

EVALUATION

1. Who is known as the "Father of Modern Nigerian Art," and what style did he champion?
2. What was the philosophy of the "Zaria Rebels" called, and what did it mean?
3. Name three members of the Zaria Art Society and their area of specialization.
4. Who is Ladi Kwali, and what two traditions did she blend in her work?



WEEK 5: CUBISM

5.1 INTRODUCTION (THE SECOND "REVOLUTION")

- **Cubism** was a revolutionary art movement of the early 20th century (c. 1907-1914), created by **Pablo Picasso** (Spanish) and **Georges Braque** (French).
- It is considered the *most influential* art movement of the 20th century.
- **Core Idea:** Cubism *abandoned* the 500-year-old tradition of linear perspective (art as a "window"). Instead of painting an object from *one* fixed viewpoint, it showed the object from *multiple viewpoints at the same time*, breaking it down into geometric planes.



5.2 THE INFLUENCE OF AFRICAN ART

- A key inspiration for Cubism was **traditional African art**.
- In 1907, Picasso visited the Trocadéro Museum in Paris and saw African masks (e.g., Fang masks). He was "shocked" by their power.
- He realized African artists did *not* care about "visual realism." They carved what they *knew* (the *concept* of a face), not what they *saw*.

- Picasso's "revolutionary" painting, *Les Femmes d'Alger (O.J.)* (1907), which is the first "Cubist" painting, features faces directly inspired by these "primitive" African masks.

5.3 TYPES AND STYLES

1. ANALYTICAL CUBISM (1907–1911):

- The "early" phase.
- **Style:** The artists would "analyze" a subject (like a person or a guitar), breaking it into fragmented geometric planes.
- **Characteristics:** Monochromatic (using only browns, greys, and blacks), complex, abstract, and difficult to read.
- **Exponents:** Picasso and Braque.

2. SYNTHETIC CUBISM (1912–1914):

- The "later" phase.
- **Style:** The artists "synthesized" (built up) an image from simpler shapes.
- **Characteristics:** More colour, simpler forms, and the invention of **Collage**—the practice of gluing non-art materials (like newspaper, rope, or wood) onto the canvas.
- **Exponents:** Picasso, Braque, Juan Gris.

5.4 CHARACTERISTICS OF CUBISM

- **Geometric:** Objects are reduced to basic shapes (cubes, spheres, cylinders).
- **Multiple Viewpoints:** You see the front, side, and back of an object at the same time.
- **Flat (2D):** Rejects the illusion of 3D depth; the painting is a flat object.
- **Monochromatic (at first):** Colour was secondary to form and structure.

5.5 INFLUENCE OF CUBISM ON AFRICAN ART

This is a **two-way street**:

1. **African Art -> Cubism:** African masks gave Picasso the "permission" and inspiration to break free from European realism.

2. **Cubism -> African Art:** Later, modern Nigerian artists (like the Zaria Rebels) were influenced by Cubism's geometric abstractions. They saw in Cubism a "re-connection" to the conceptual, non-realistic nature of their own traditional art.

EVALUATION

1. What is the core idea of Cubism?
2. Who were the two founders of the Cubism movement?
3. Explain the "two-way" influence between African Art and Cubism.
4. What is the difference between "Analytical" and "Synthetic" Cubism?
5. What new technique did Synthetic Cubism introduce to the art world?

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. Take a simple object (like a cup or a bottle).
2. Draw it in the Cubist style. Do not draw it from one angle.
3. Try to show the top opening (a circle) and the side view (a silhouette) at the *same time*. Break the forms into sharp, geometric planes.

WEEK 6: FURNITURE

6.1 INTRODUCTION

Furniture refers to movable objects (like chairs, tables, beds, cabinets) intended to support human activities, provide storage, or hold objects at a convenient height.

Furniture Design is a specialized field of art and design that combines aesthetics (how it looks) with ergonomics (how it functions for the human body).



6.2 FUNCTIONS OF FURNITURE

1. **Support (Ergonomics):** To provide safe and comfortable support for the human body (e.g., chairs, beds, stools).
2. **Storage:** To hold and organize objects (e.g., cabinets, shelves, wardrobes, chests).
3. **Surface:** To provide a flat surface for work or display (e.g., tables, desks, counters).
4. **Aesthetic:** To enhance the beauty and style of a space.
5. **Social:** To define a space and status (e.g., a "throne" or *oba's* chair is a symbol of power).
6. **Multi-functional:** Modern furniture often combines functions (e.g., a storage "ottoman" that is also a seat).



6.3 MATERIALS IN FURNITURE DESIGN

- **Wood:** The most common material (Hardwoods: Iroko, Mahogany; Softwoods: Pine; Manufactured: Plywood, MDF).
- **Metal:** (Steel, Iron, Aluminium): For frames, legs; durable.
- **Plastic/Polymers:** Can be moulded into any shape; cheap, versatile.
- **Glass:** For tabletops.
- **Upholstery (Coverings):**
 - **Leather:** Durable, high-status, easy to clean, expensive.
 - **Fabric:** (Cotton, Linen, Synthetic): Huge variety of colours and patterns, comfortable, can be harder to clean.

6.4 PROCESSES OF FURNITURE MAKING (A BASIC OVERVIEW)

1. **Design:** Sketching the idea, creating a technical drawing with exact dimensions.
2. **Sourcing Materials:** Selecting the appropriate wood, fabric, foam, etc.
3. **Construction (Joinery):** Cutting the wood and joining the pieces together (e.g., using nails, screws, glue, or complex joints like Mortise & Tenon).
4. **Finishing:** Sanding the wood smooth, then applying a finish (e.g., stain, varnish, paint).
5. **Upholstering:** If it's a soft furnishing, this involves adding foam padding and covering it with the chosen fabric or leather.

6.5 MARKETING AND OUTLETS

- **Local Workshops:** The most common outlet in Nigeria. Carpenters make furniture to order.
- **Showrooms:** Large stores that display and sell pre-made furniture.
- **Online Stores:** E-commerce sites (e.g., Jumia, specialist stores).
- **Interior Designers:** They commission or select furniture for clients.
- **Niche/Art Furniture:** High-end, one-of-a-kind "art" pieces (like those by Demas Nwoko) sold in galleries.

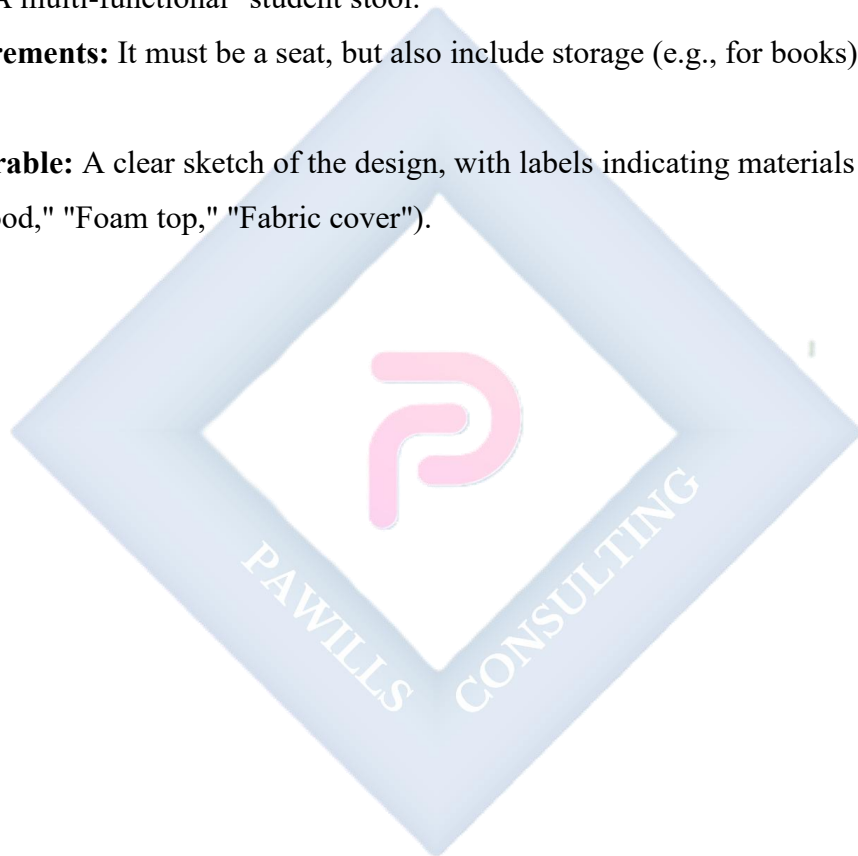
EVALUATION

1. What is "Ergonomics" in furniture design?

2. List the five main functions of furniture.
3. Compare the use of Leather vs. Fabric in upholstery (one pro and one con for each).
4. List the 5 basic steps in constructing a piece of furniture.
5. Name three different "outlets" for selling furniture products.

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. **Design a piece of furniture on paper.**
2. **Item:** A multi-functional "student stool."
3. **Requirements:** It must be a seat, but also include storage (e.g., for books) and be easy to carry.
4. **Deliverable:** A clear sketch of the design, with labels indicating materials (e.g., "Plywood," "Foam top," "Fabric cover").



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK



WEEK 8: ORIENTAL AND OCEANIC ART

8.1 INTRODUCTION

- **Oriental Art:** A broad term for the art originating from **East Asia** (China, Japan, Korea) and **South Asia** (India).
- **Oceanic Art:** The art of the indigenous peoples of the **Pacific Islands** (Polynesia, Micronesia, Melanesia) and Australia.

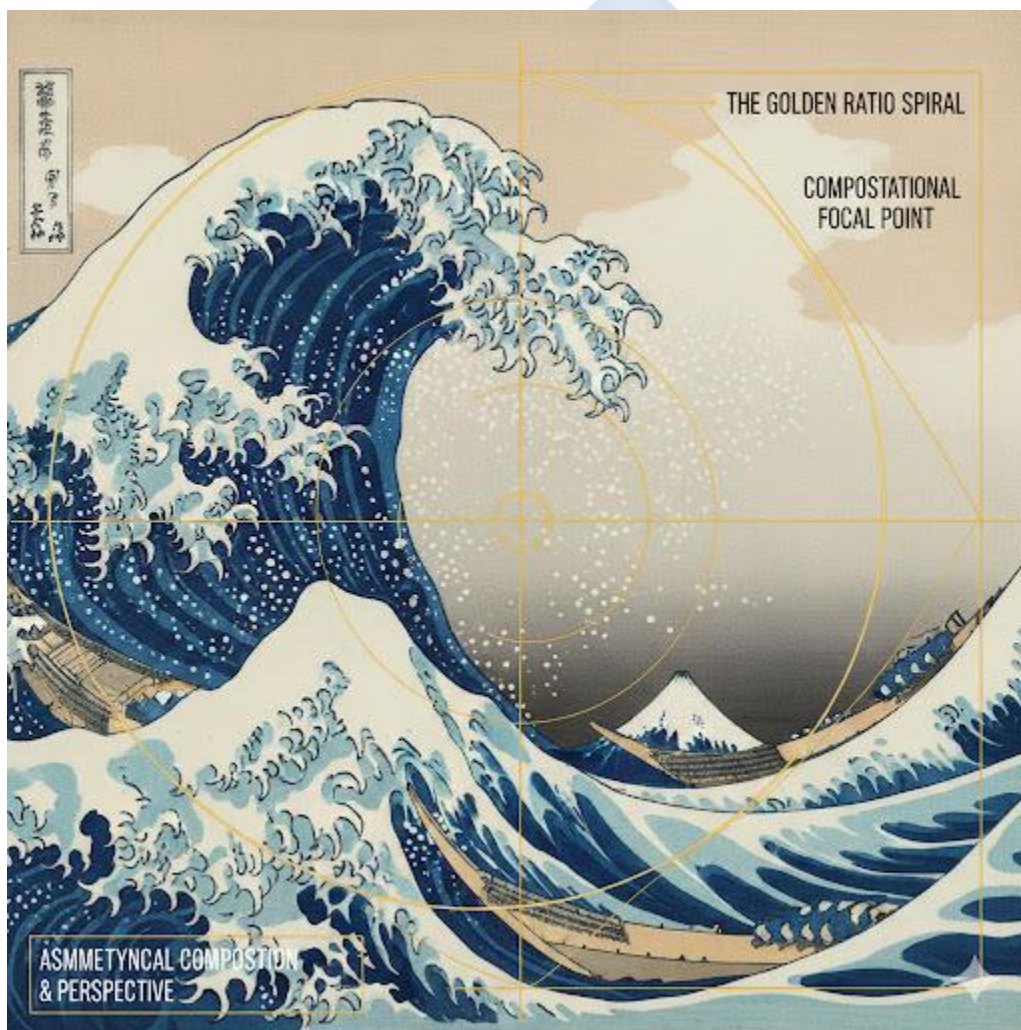


8.2 ORIENTAL ART: CHARACTERISTICS

A. CHINESE ART

- **Philosophy:** Deeply influenced by Taoism, Buddhism, and Confucianism. Emphasizes **harmony with nature**.

- **Subject: Landscapes** are considered the highest form of painting. Figures are often tiny, showing humanity's small place in the vastness of nature.
- **Media: Ink and Wash Painting** on silk or paper.
- **Characteristics:**
 - Calligraphy is a high art form; the brushstroke is paramount.
 - "Less is more" - empty space is as important as the painted areas.
 - **Porcelain (Ceramics):** Highly advanced; "china" (e.g., blue and white porcelain) was a major export.



B. JAPANESE ART

- **Philosophy:** Influenced by Chinese art, but adapted with a focus on **Zen Buddhism** and **Wabi-Sabi** (the beauty of imperfection, transience, and simplicity).
- **Media:**
 - **Ukiyo-e (Woodblock Prints):** "Pictures of the Floating World." Mass-produced prints of actors, courtesans, and landscapes. *The Great Wave off Kanagawa* by **Hokusai** is the most famous.
 - **Ceramics:** Raku ware (used in tea ceremonies).
- **Characteristics:** Focus on line, flat areas of colour, asymmetrical balance.

C. INDIAN ART

- **Philosophy:** Deeply religious, serving **Hinduism** and **Buddhism**.
- **Subject:** Deities, religious narratives, and spiritual figures.
- **Media:** **Stone Sculpture** (on temples) and **Bronze Casting**.
- **Characteristics:**
 - Vibrant, ornate, and full of sensual figures.
 - **Symbolism:** Every pose (*mudra*) and object has a specific religious meaning.
 - **Example:** Bronze statues of the Hindu god **Shiva** as *Nataraja* (Lord of the Dance).

8.3 OCEANIC ART: CHARACTERISTICS

- **Context:** Art is not "art for art's sake." It is deeply **spiritual, functional, and connected to ancestors**.
- **Materials:** Natural, perishable materials (wood, shells, feathers, bone, plant fibres).

A. POLYNESIAN ART (e.g., New Zealand, Hawaii, Easter Island)

- **Focus:** Ancestor worship, genealogy, and mana (spiritual power).
- **Examples:**
 - **Maori (New Zealand):** Intricate curvilinear carvings on canoes and meeting houses; *Moko* (facial tattoos).

- **Rapa Nui (Easter Island):** The giant stone statues (*Moai*), believed to represent ancestors.

B. MICRONESIAN ART (e.g., Caroline Islands)

- **Focus:** Practicality and function, especially for seafaring.
- **Examples:**
 - Carved boat prows.
 - **"Stick Charts":** An amazing form of "art" showing ocean swell patterns for navigating the open ocean.

C. MELANESIAN ART (e.g., Papua New Guinea)

- **Focus:** Highly spiritual, vibrant, and expressive.
- **Examples:** Elaborate and colourful **masks**, canoes, and "spirit houses" used in rituals.

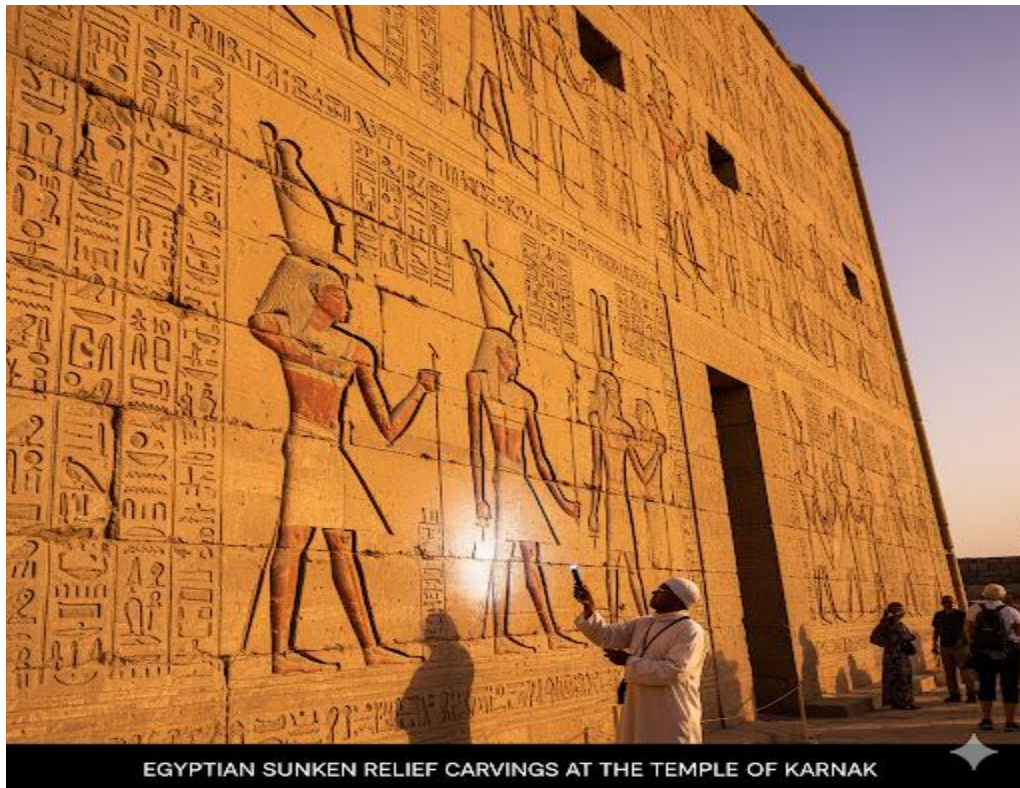
EVALUATION

1. What is the *highest* form of painting in traditional Chinese art, and why?
2. What is a "Ukiyo-e" print? Name the most famous example.
3. How does the subject matter of Indian art (e.g., a Shiva statue) differ from Chinese art?
4. What is the general function of Oceanic art (e.g., in Polynesia)?
5. What are the *Moai* of Easter Island?

WEEK 9: SCULPTURE (RELIEF)

9.1 INTRODUCTION

Sculpture is the three-dimensional branch of visual art. **Relief Sculpture** is a type of sculpture that is *not* free-standing (sculpture-in-the-round). It is attached to a flat background (a "ground"), and the image projects from this ground. Examples are found on walls, monuments, and coins.



9.2 TYPES OF RELIEF

1. Bas-Relief (or Low Relief):

- The design projects *only slightly* from the background.
- The "depth" of the carving is very shallow.
- **Example:** The profile of a person on a **coin**.

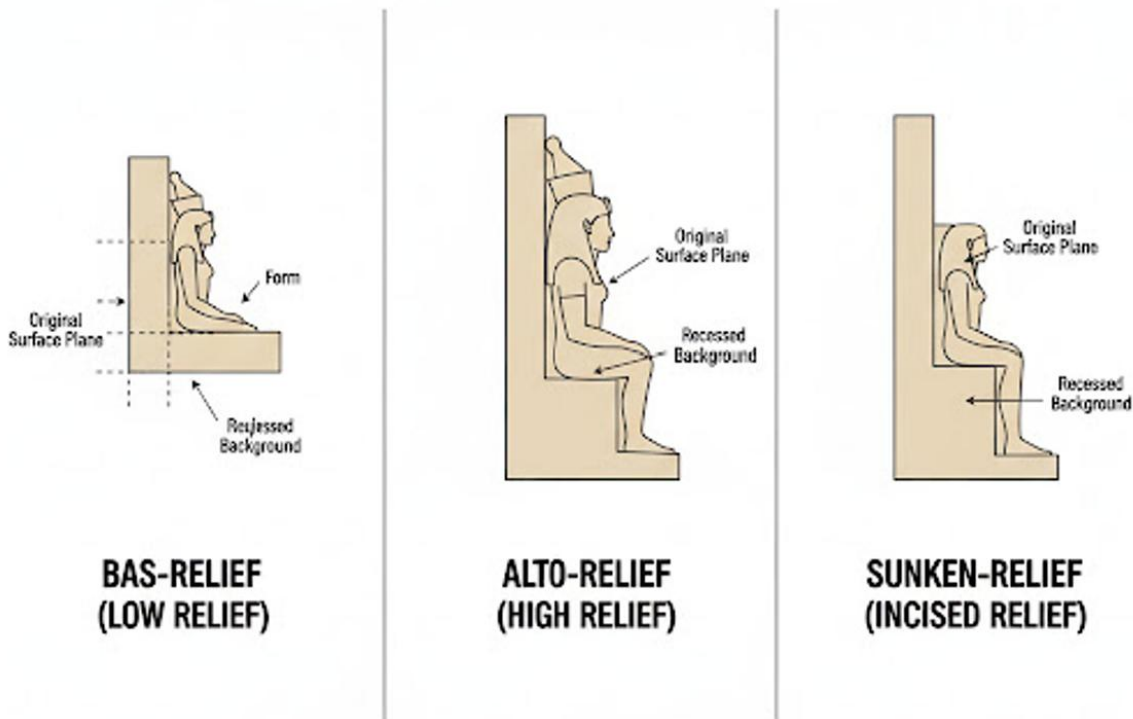
2. Alto-Relief (or High Relief):

- The design projects *significantly* from the background, by at least half its natural depth.

- Some parts (like a hand or a head) may be completely "undercut" and detached from the background.
- **Example:** Many monumental Greek and Roman wall sculptures.

3. Sunken Relief (or Intaglio):

- The design is *carved into* the background.
- The highest points of the sculpture are level with the original surface.
- **Example:** Widely used in **Ancient Egypt**.



9.3 MATERIALS AND TOOLS

- **Clay (Additive):**
 - Materials: Earthenware clay.
 - Tools: Modeling tools (wood/wire loops), spatulas, rolling pins, water.
- **Plaster of Paris (POP) (Subtractive or Casting):**
 - Materials: POP powder, water, hessian (jute) for reinforcement.
 - Tools: Chisels, scrapers, rasps, sandpaper (for carving).
- **Wood (Subtractive):**

- Materials: Wood (e.g., Obeche, Mahogany).
- Tools: Chisels, gouges (U-shaped), V-tools, mallet.
- **Cement (Casting):**
 - Materials: Cement, sand, gravel, water, armature (metal frame).
 - Tools: Trowels, spatulas.
- **Metal (Repoussé/Chasing):**
 - Materials: Thin metal sheet (copper, brass).
 - Tools: Hammers, punches.

9.4 PROCESSES OF CREATING A RELIEF

This example uses **Clay (Additive/Modelling)**:

1. **Prepare the Ground:** Roll out a flat, even slab of clay to serve as the background.
2. **Transfer Design:** Lightly sketch your design onto the clay slab.
3. **Build Up Forms:** Add coils, pieces, and slabs of clay to "build up" the design, starting with the largest forms.
4. **Model Details:** Use smaller tools to model the fine details (e.g., facial features, textures).
5. **Refine:** Ensure the highest points are (for example) 2cm high, and the lowest points blend smoothly into the background.
6. **Dry & Fire:** Allow the clay to dry (leather-hard, then bone-dry) before firing it in a kiln to make it permanent.

9.5 FINISHING

- **Clay:** Can be **glazed** (painted with liquid glass) before the final firing for a colourful, glossy finish.
- **POP/Cement:** Can be sealed (with PVA glue) and then **painted** (with acrylics or oil).
- **Wood:** Can be **sanded** smooth and then **stained** (to show the grain) or **varnished**.

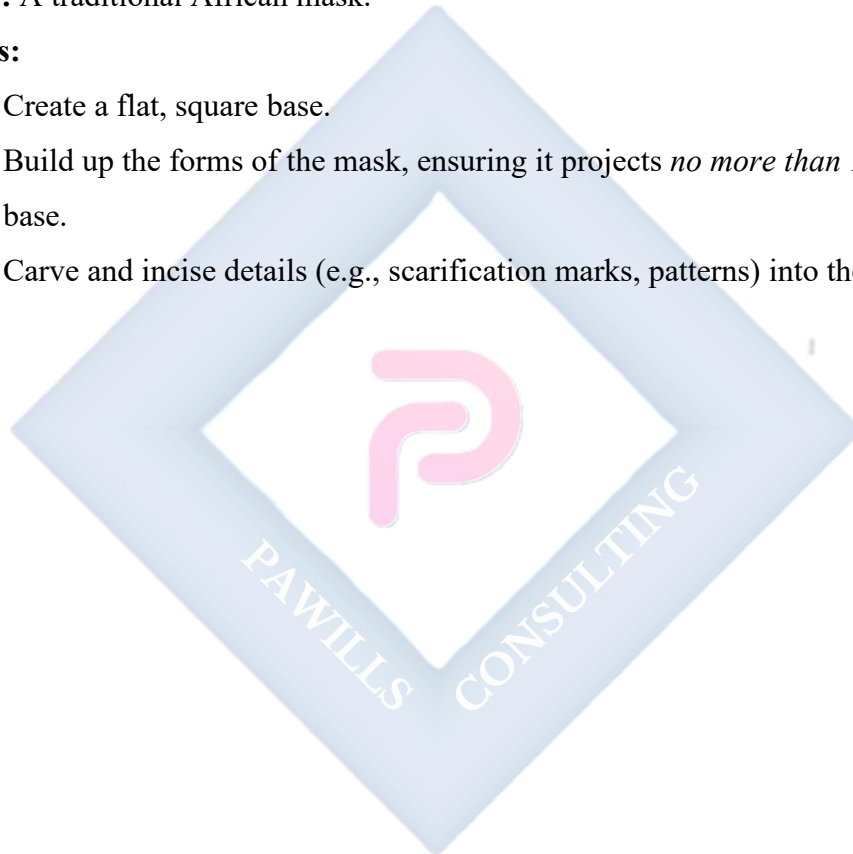
EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between a relief sculpture and a sculpture-in-the-round?

2. Explain the difference between "Bas-Relief" and "High-Relief."
3. What is "Sunken Relief," and which ancient civilization famously used it?
4. Is modeling in clay an "additive" or "subtractive" process? Why?

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

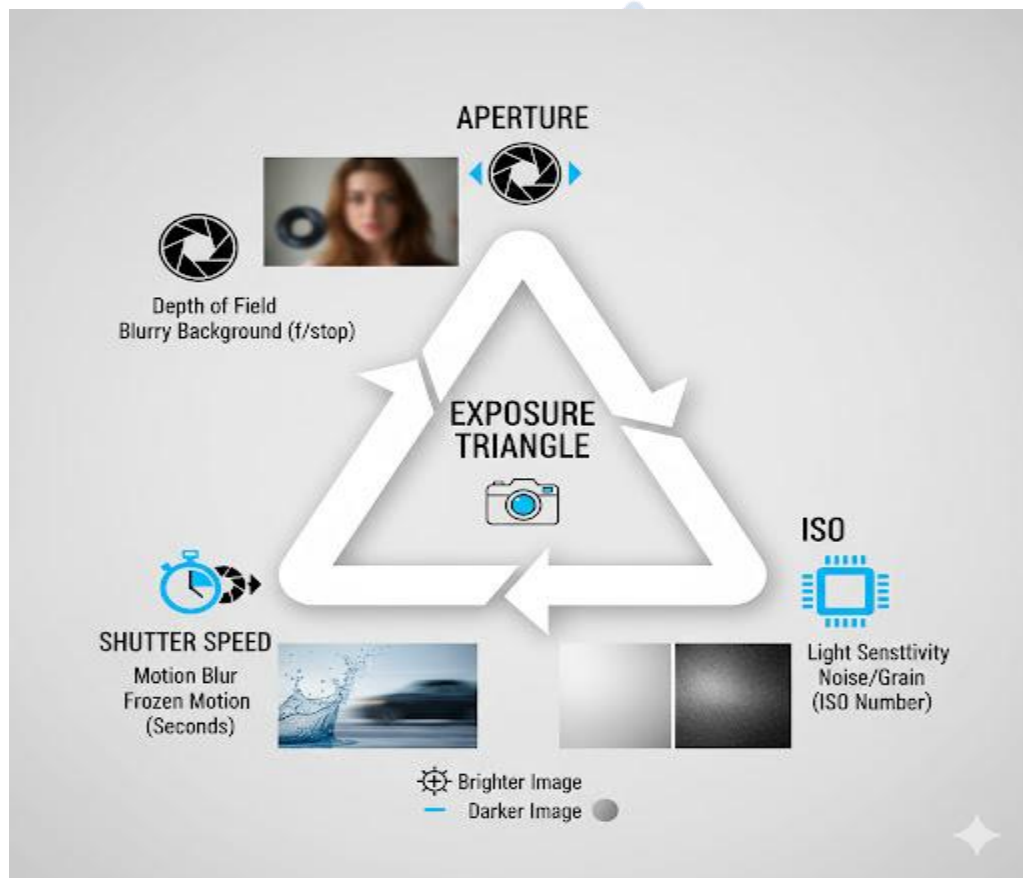
1. **Create a Bas-Relief Plaque (15cm x 15cm).**
2. **Material:** Clay (or a substitute like salt dough, or even soap carving).
3. **Theme:** A traditional African mask.
4. **Process:**
 - Create a flat, square base.
 - Build up the forms of the mask, ensuring it projects *no more than 1-2cm* from the base.
 - Carve and incise details (e.g., scarification marks, patterns) into the surface.



WEEK 10: PHOTOGRAPHY

10.1 WHAT IS PHOTOGRAPHY?

- **Definition:** The word comes from Greek: *photos* ("light") and *graphé* ("drawing").
Photography is the art, science, and practice of "drawing with light."
- It involves creating a durable image by recording light (or other electromagnetic radiation) onto a light-sensitive material (like film) or an electronic sensor (in a digital camera).



10.2 OPERATING A CAMERA: THE "EXPOSURE TRIANGLE"

To create a good photograph, you must control the *amount of light* that reaches the sensor. This is controlled by three settings:

1. **Aperture:**
 - **What it is:** The *opening* in the lens.

- **Measured in:** f-stops (e.g., f/1.8, f/4, f/16).
- **Effect:** Controls **Depth of Field (DOF)**.
 - **Large Aperture** (e.g., f/1.8 - "wide open"): Lets in *more* light, creates a *shallow* DOF (blurry background - good for portraits).
 - **Small Aperture** (e.g., f/16 - "closed down"): Lets in *less* light, creates a *deep* DOF (everything in focus - good for landscapes).

2. Shutter Speed:

- **What it is:** The *time* the shutter stays open, exposing the sensor to light.
- **Measured in:** Seconds or fractions of a second (e.g., 1/1000s, 1/60s, 1s).
- **Effect:** Controls **Motion**.
 - **Fast Shutter Speed** (e.g., 1/1000s): *Freezes* action (a running person, a water droplet).
 - **Slow Shutter Speed** (e.g., 1s): Creates *motion blur* (shows the movement of a car's taillights at night, makes waterfalls look silky).

3. ISO:

- **What it is:** The *sensitivity* of the camera's sensor to light.
- **Effect:** Controls "noise" or "grain."
 - **Low ISO** (e.g., 100): Low sensitivity, for bright light. Creates a clean, high-quality image.
 - **High ISO** (e.g., 3200): High sensitivity, for dark situations. Creates a grainy, "noisy" image.

A good exposure is a *balance* of all three.

COMPOSITION: RULE OF THIRDS VS. DEAD-CENTER

RULE OF THIRDS



DEAD-CENTER



10.3 TERMINOLOGIES IN PHOTOGRAPHY (COMPOSITION)

- **Rule of Thirds:** A composition guide. Imagine your frame is divided by a 3x3 grid. The most interesting points to place your subject are on the *intersections* of these lines, not in the centre.
- **Leading Lines:** Using natural lines in the scene (a road, a fence, a river) to "lead" the viewer's eye towards the main subject.
- **Framing:** Using elements in the foreground (like a doorway or a tree branch) to create a "frame" around your main subject.
- **Depth of Field (DOF):** The area of the image that is in sharp focus.
- **Bokeh:** The aesthetic *quality* of the background blur (not just the *amount* of blur).

10.4 FILM MAKING

- **Film Making (Cinematography)** is a related but distinct art form.

- It uses the same principles of exposure and composition, but it involves capturing *moving* images (e.g., 24 frames per second).
- It also involves other elements: **narrative (story)**, **sound (dialogue, music)**, and **editing (montage)**.

10.5 RELEVANCE OF PHOTOGRAPHY IN VISUAL ARTS

1. **An Art Form in Itself: Fine Art Photography** (e.g., portraits, landscapes) is exhibited in galleries just like painting.
2. **A Commercial Tool:** Essential for **Graphic Design, Advertising, and Fashion Design**.
3. **A Documentation Tool:** Used by artists to document their work (e.g., taking a photo of a sculpture or painting) for portfolios or reproduction.
4. **A Reference Tool:** Painters and sculptors often use photographs as a reference for their work.

EVALUATION

1. What is the "Exposure Triangle"? Name its three components.
2. If you want to take a portrait with a very blurry background, what kind of aperture would you use (large or small)?
3. If you want to "freeze" the motion of a fast-moving car, what kind of shutter speed would you use (fast or slow)?
4. What is the "Rule of Thirds" in composition?
5. List two ways photography is relevant to a painter or sculptor.

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. Using any camera (a phone camera is perfect), find three examples of **Leading Lines** in your environment (e.g., the edge of a road, a fence, a pattern on the floor).
2. Take a photo of each, trying to place the subject at the *end* of the line.

WEEK 11: REVISION

- **General review of all topics covered during the term.** This week is for consolidating knowledge from all previous weeks, from practical skills (Week 1) to art history (Weeks 2, 3, 5, 8) and specialized arts (Weeks 4, 6, 9, 10).

REVISION QUIZ

1. What is the main difference between oil paint and acrylic paint? (Week 1)
2. What was the "Rebirth" of in the Renaissance? (Week 2)
3. Who painted "en plein air" to capture light? (Week 3)
4. What was "Natural Synthesis"? (Week 4)
5. What non-European art form inspired Picasso's Cubism? (Week 5)
6. "Ergonomics" relates to which function of furniture? (Week 6)
7. *Ukiyo-e* is a form of art from which country? (Week 8)
8. A coin is an example of what kind of sculpture? (Week 9)
9. A slow shutter speed creates what effect? (Week 10)

SS3 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: CULTURAL AND CREATIVE ARTS

1.1 INTRODUCTION: VALUING AND APPRAISING CCA

Culture is the total way of life of a group of people, including their beliefs, language, customs, and art. **Creativity** is the act of using imagination and skill to produce new and original ideas or objects.

Cultural and Creative Arts (CCA) is a broad, interdisciplinary field that encompasses all artistic and cultural expressions of a society. It is the "soul" of a nation, reflecting its identity, history, and values. Appraising CCA means learning to understand, critique, and place value on these diverse art forms.



1.2 COMPONENTS OF CULTURAL AND CREATIVE ARTS

CCA is a "family" of related disciplines, which includes:

1. **FINE ART:** This is the "art for art's sake" category, created primarily for aesthetic, intellectual, or emotional expression.
 - **Examples:** Drawing, Painting, Sculpture (in-the-round, relief).
2. **APPLIED ART:** This is art that applies aesthetic design to functional, everyday objects. It has a practical use.
 - **Examples:** Graphic Design (posters, logos), Textile Design (fabric), Ceramics (pottery), Fashion Design (clothing), Furniture Design, Jewellery.
3. **MUSIC:** The art of organizing sound and silence in time. It includes vocal (singing) and instrumental (e.g., drums, piano, guitar) forms.
 - **Examples:** Traditional/Folk, Classical, Pop, Afrobeat.
4. **DRAMA (Theatre Arts):** The art of performance, storytelling, and acting. It involves role-playing, movement, and speech.
 - **Examples:** Stage plays, traditional masquerades, festivals, filmmaking (Nollywood).
5. **DANCE:** The art of using the body's movement, often rhythmically to music, as a form of expression.
 - **Examples:** Traditional ethnic dances (e.g., *Atilogwu*, *Bata*), contemporary dance, ballet.
6. **MEDIA ART:** Modern art forms that use technology.
 - **Examples:** Photography, Filmmaking, Animation, Digital Art.
7. **LITERATURE:** Written or oral art forms.
 - **Examples:** Poetry, prose (novels), oral folklore, proverbs.

1.3 FUNCTIONS OF CULTURAL AND CREATIVE ARTS IN SOCIETY

NIGERIAN CREATIVE ARTS: FROM TRADITION TO GLOBAL STAGE



FUNCTIONAL DESIGN & INTERDISCIPLINARY EXPRESSION

Art is not just "decoration"; it is essential to the functioning of a society.

1. **Cultural Preservation & Identity:** Art (especially festivals, crafts, and dances) is the primary way a society's history, myths, and values are preserved and passed to the next generation.
2. **Communication:** Art communicates ideas, beliefs, and emotions that words alone cannot. (e.g., a protest song, a political sculpture, a warning mask).
3. **Social Commentary & Critique:** Artists often act as the "conscience" of society, using their work to criticize government, expose social problems (like corruption or poverty), and provoke thought.
4. **Religious & Ritualistic Function:** In traditional societies, art is central to religious practice (e.g., shrines, masks, masquerades, religious music).
5. **Aesthetic & Decorative Function:** Art provides beauty to our environment, enhancing our quality of life (e.g., a beautiful building, a decorated pot, a painting).

6. **Economic Function:** CCA creates a massive industry. It provides employment for millions as artists, designers, musicians, actors, curators, and craftspeople. It also drives tourism.
7. **Therapeutic & Emotional Function:** Engaging with art (creating or observing) can be therapeutic, helping to relieve stress, process emotions, and improve mental well-being.

1.4 DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FINE ART AND APPLIED ART

This is a fundamental concept in visual arts.

Feature	FINE ART (e.g., Painting, Sculpture)	APPLIED ART (e.g., Graphic Design, Ceramics)
Primary Purpose	Aesthetic / Expression: "Art for art's sake." To be looked at and contemplated.	Functional / Utility: "Art with a function." To be used.
Focus	Self-expression of the artist, emotional impact, conceptual ideas.	Solving a practical problem (e.g., a comfortable chair, an eye-catching logo).
End Product	A unique, "one-of-a-kind" object (e.g., a single painting, a bronze sculpture).	Often mass-produced (e.g., thousands of copies of a poster, a set of dishes).
Value	Based on aesthetic quality, originality, and the artist's reputation.	Based on usability, craftsmanship, and aesthetic appeal.
Example	A painting of a soup can by Andy Warhol (Fine Art).	The label <i>design</i> for the soup can (Applied Art).

EVALUATION

1. Define Cultural and Creative Arts (CCA).
2. List the five main components of CCA.
3. Explain three (3) major functions of art in society.
4. What is the *primary* difference between Fine Art and Applied Art? Give one example of each.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Look around your home or school. Identify five objects. Classify each as either "Fine Art," "Applied Art," or "Craft," and write one sentence justifying your choice.



WEEK 2: IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION

2.1 MEANING OF IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION

Imaginative Composition is the art of creating a drawing or painting from the artist's **imagination, memory, or knowledge**, rather than from direct observation of a live model, landscape, or still life setup.

It is a test of the artist's total skill: not just *how* to draw, but *what* to draw. It requires mastery of perspective, human anatomy, colour theory, and, most importantly, the principles of design (balance, unity, etc.).

2.2 THE PICTURE PLANE: GROUNDS IN COMPOSITION

To create a convincing illusion of depth and space in an imaginative composition, the artist must organize the "picture plane" (the 2D surface) into distinct "grounds" or "planes."

1. FOREGROUND:

- This is the area of the picture that appears **closest** to the viewer.
- **Characteristics:** Objects are drawn **largest** and at the **bottom** of the picture. They have the **most detail, sharpest focus, and strongest, warmest colours**.

2. MIDDLE GROUND:

- This is the area between the foreground and the background.
- **Characteristics:** It is typically the **main area of interest** where the primary subject or action is happening. Objects are mid-sized, with good detail, but less than the foreground.

3. BACKGROUND:

- This is the area of the picture that appears **farthest** from the viewer.
- **Characteristics:** Objects are drawn **smallest** and at the **top** of the picture. They have the **least detail, softest focus, and lightest, coolest colours** (this is called **Atmospheric Perspective**).

2.3 THEMES (NOT "TYPES") OF GROUNDS IN IMAGINATIVE COMPOSITION

The scheme of work lists "types of grounds" (market scene, etc.). These are more accurately described as common **themes** or **subjects** for imaginative composition.

1. **Market Scene:** A classic and complex theme.

- **Opportunities:** Shows crowds, perspective, vibrant colour, cultural details (goods, clothing), and interaction.

2. **Festival Scene:**

- **Opportunities:** Shows movement (dancing), elaborate costumes (masquerades), energy, and cultural traditions.

3. **Village Scene:**

- **Opportunities:** Shows atmosphere (e.g., quiet, rustic), landscape, traditional architecture (huts), and daily life (e.g., women at the stream, elders under a tree).

4. **Still Life (from imagination):**

- **Opportunities:** A good way to practice composition and shading without a real setup. The artist must *imagine* the light source and how it hits the (imagined) objects.

5. **Other Scenes:** "A political rally," "A naming ceremony," "A football match," "A busy bus stop."

2.4 MATERIALS AND PRODUCTION

- **Materials:** Standard drawing and painting materials (pencils, charcoal, pastels, watercolours, poster colours, acrylics, canvas, paper).
- **Production Process (Organising the Composition):**
 1. **Choose a Theme:** (e.g., "Market Scene").
 2. **Research & Brainstorm:** What elements belong? (Sellers, buyers, children, animals, stalls, goods like yams, peppers).
 3. **Thumbnail Sketches: THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT STEP.** Make 3-5 *small, rough sketches* to plan your composition. Decide on your **focal point** (the main action) and how to arrange the figures and objects.

4. **Establish the Grounds:** Draw the full-size version. Start by drawing the main figures/objects in the foreground, middle ground, and background to establish scale and depth.
5. **Add Details:** Fill in the composition, ensuring all parts relate (unity).
6. **Apply Colour & Value:** Use colour and shading to enhance the mood and depth.
Remember: **warm colours advance (come forward), cool colours recede (go back).**

EVALUATION

1. What is imaginative composition?
2. Name and describe the three "grounds" of a picture plane.
3. What is "Atmospheric Perspective"?
4. Why is it important to make "thumbnail sketches" *before* starting a final composition?

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose one of the following themes: "A Busy Bus Stop" or "A Naming Ceremony."
2. Create **three (3)** different thumbnail sketches (no bigger than your palm) for your chosen theme.
3. Select the best sketch and produce a full-page, finished pencil drawing, paying clear attention to the foreground, middle ground, and background.

WEEK 3: CRAFT IN NIGERIA

3.1 MEANING OF ART AND CRAFT

- **Art:** A broad field, often focused on the expression of ideas and emotions (e.g., a painting).
- **Craft:** A specific field that emphasizes **skill**, **utility (function)**, and **tradition**. A craft is a skilled trade involving making things by hand, often using indigenous materials and techniques passed down through generations.
- **Distinction:** All craft requires art (design, aesthetics), and all art requires craft (skill, technique). However, "Craft" *prioritizes* the skill and the functional object.

3.2 MATERIALS AND TOOLS FOR CRAFT

Each craft has its specialized tools and materials.

- **Ceramics (Pottery):**
 - Materials: Clay, Water, Glaze, Firewood/Gas (for firing).
 - Tools: Coiling/pinching hands, spatula, wheel, kiln.
- **Textiles (Weaving & Dyeing):**
 - Materials: Cotton/yarn, Indigo (elu) dyes, wax (batik), raffia (adire).
 - Tools: Loom (horizontal for men, vertical for women), shuttle, calabash, stencils.
- **Metalwork (Bronze Casting):**
 - Materials: Beeswax, clay (mould), bronze/brass, fire.
 - Tools: Crucibles, forge, files.
- **Leatherwork:**
 - Materials: Animal hides/skins (Goat, Snake), Dyes.
 - Tools: Knives, awls, needles, punches.
- **Wood Carving:**
 - Materials: Wood (Iroko, Mahogany, Obeche).
 - Tools: Axe, adze, chisels, gouges, mallet.

3.3 ORIGIN/LOCATION OF CRAFT PRODUCTION IN NIGERIA ("CRAFT MAP")

Nigeria has a rich and diverse craft heritage, localized by resources and tradition.

- **Textile (Weaving):**
 - **Iseyin (Oyo):** Famous for *Aso-Ofi* (men's horizontal loom).
 - **Okene (Kogi):** Famous for their unique woven cloths.
 - **Akwete (Abia):** Famous for *Akwete* cloth (women's vertical loom).
- **Textile (Dyeing):**
 - **Abeokuta (Ogun):** The "home" of *Adire* (indigo-dyed cloth).
 - **Kano:** Famous for its ancient indigo dye pits.
- **Bronze/Brass Casting:**
 - **Benin City (Edo):** World-famous for its *lost-wax (cire-perdue)* brass plaques and heads.
 - **Ife (Osun):** Famed for its highly naturalistic brass heads.
 - **Bida (Niger):** Known for brass casting and glass beads.
- **Pottery (Ceramics):**
 - **Abuja (Suleja):** Home of **Ladi Kwali** and the Gwari pottery tradition.
 - **Ilorin (Kwara):** A major centre for pottery.
- **Wood Carving:**
 - **Benin (Edo):** Famous for its carved tusks and wooden heads.
 - **Awka (Anambra):** Famed for its carvers and blacksmiths.
- **Leatherwork:**
 - **Kano, Sokoto, Maiduguri:** The "Sudan" region is famous for tanned leather goods (puffs, bags, slippers).
- **Calabash Decoration:**
 - **Oyo & North-East:** Known for carving, scraping, and burning designs onto dried gourds.

3.4 FUNCTIONS & CHARACTERISTICS OF CRAFTS

- **Functions:**
 - **Utility:** Most crafts start as functional items (a pot for water, cloth for wearing).
 - **Religious/Ritual:** (e.g., carved Egungun mask, a shrine pot).

- **Status Symbol:** (e.g., royal Aso-Ofi, Benin bronze heads).
- **Economic:** Provides a livelihood for the craftspeople and trade for the community.
- **Characteristics:**
 - Hand-made, not industrial.
 - Uses local, natural materials.
 - Techniques are passed down (apprenticeship).
 - Designs are often traditional, symbolic, and culturally specific.

3.5 RELATION TO MODERN ART

Traditional crafts are the "root" of modern Nigerian art. The "Zaria Rebels" (Bruce Onobrakpeya, Uche Okeke) based their "Natural Synthesis" philosophy on using the *motifs*, *myths*, and *techniques* of traditional crafts (like Uli painting, Urhobo carving) in their modern, contemporary art.

EVALUATION

1. What is the main difference between "Craft" and "Art"?
2. Name three (3) craft centres in Nigeria and the specific craft they are famous for. (e.g., Benin - Bronze Casting).
3. What is the *lost-wax* (cire-perdue) method used for?
4. List three functions of traditional crafts.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Choose one Nigerian craft (e.g., Adire, Aso-Ofi, Benin Bronze). Write a short paragraph describing its materials, its traditional function, and how it is used in a *modern* way today.

WEEK 4: ART TERMINOLOGIES

4.1 EXPLANATION

Art Terminologies are the specialized vocabulary, or "language," that artists, art historians, and critics use to describe, analyze, and interpret works of art. To "speak" about art, you must know the correct terms.

4.2 KEY ART TERMINOLOGIES (GLOSSARY)

This is a foundational list of terms, essential for both theory and practical work.

A. ELEMENTS OF ART (The "Building Blocks")

1. **Line:** A mark with length and direction. (e.g., horizontal, vertical, curved, implied).
2. **Shape:** A flat, enclosed, 2D area. (e.g., **Geometric:** square, circle; **Organic:** leaf-shape).
3. **Form:** A 3D object, or the *illusion* of a 3D object. Has height, width, and depth. (e.g., cube, sphere, pyramid, a person).
4. **Colour:** The visual property derived from reflected light.
 - **Hue:** The name of the colour (e.g., red, blue).
 - **Value:** The lightness or darkness (e.g., red + white = pink).
 - **Intensity:** The brightness or dullness (e.g., pure red vs. reddish-brown).
5. **Value (or Tone):** The range of light to dark in a work. This is what creates *Chiaroscuro* (the illusion of 3D form).
6. **Texture:** The surface quality of an object.
 - **Actual Texture:** How it *really* feels (e.g., a rough sculpture).
 - **Implied Texture:** How it *looks* like it feels (e.g., a painting of soft fur).
7. **Space:** The area around, between, or within objects.
 - **Positive Space:** The subject itself.
 - **Negative Space:** The "empty" area around the subject.

B. PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN (How the "Blocks" are organized)

1. **Balance:** The visual "weight" of a composition.

- **Symmetrical:** The same on both sides (like a human face).
 - **Asymmetrical:** Not the same, but "feels" balanced (e.g., one large object balanced by two small ones).
2. **Rhythm / Movement:** The visual "path" or "beat" that your eye follows, often created by repetition.
 3. **Emphasis (Focal Point):** The area that first attracts the viewer's attention.
 4. **Unity / Harmony:** The feeling that all parts of the composition "work together" and belong.
 5. **Variety:** The use of different elements (shapes, colours) to create visual interest and avoid boredom.
 6. **Proportion / Scale:** The size relationship of parts to a whole (e.g., the size of a head in relation to the body).
 7. **Repetition / Pattern:** An element (e.g., a motif) that is repeated.

C. MEDIA & TECHNIQUES

1. **Medium:** The *material* an artist uses (e.g., clay, oil paint, charcoal).
2. **Mixed Media:** Using more than one medium in a single artwork.
3. **Chiaroscuro:** (Italian: "light-dark") The dramatic use of value (light and shadow) to create the illusion of 3D form.
4. **Perspective:** The technique used to create the illusion of depth on a flat surface.
 - **Linear Perspective:** Using vanishing points and converging lines.
 - **Atmospheric Perspective:** Making distant objects lighter, bluer, and less detailed.
5. **Impasto:** Applying paint very thickly, so that the brushstrokes are visible (e.g., Van Gogh).
6. **Motif:** A repeated design, shape, or element.
7. **Collage:** (From French: "to glue") An artwork made by gluing various materials (like paper, fabric) onto a flat surface.
8. **Assemblage:** A 3D collage, made by joining "found objects."

EVALUATION

1. List the seven (7) Elements of Art.
2. List the five (5) Principles of Design.
3. What is the difference between "Shape" and "Form"?
4. Define "Chiaroscuro" and "Perspective."
5. What is the difference between "Collage" and "Assemblage"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Find a picture of a painting in a book or online (e.g., the "Mona Lisa"). Write a single paragraph *describing* it using at least **five** terminologies from this week's lesson. (e.g., "The artist uses **chiaroscuro** to model her face... the **focal point** is... the **value** of the **background** is...").



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

This week is for the Midterm Examination, covering all topics from Weeks 1-5.

- **Focus Areas:** Fine vs. Applied Art, Functions of Art, The 3 Grounds of Composition, Nigerian Craft Map, Art Terminologies (Elements & Principles), 2D vs. 3D.



WEEK 6: GENERAL TERMINOLOGIES IN 2D AND 3D ARTS

5.1 EXPLANATION

All visual art can be broadly divided into two categories: two-dimensional (2D) and three-dimensional (3D). Understanding this division is the most basic step in classifying and analyzing art.

5.2 TWO-DIMENSIONAL (2D) ART

- **Definition:** An artwork that is **flat** and has only **two (2)** dimensions: **Length and Width (or Height)**.
- **Key Concept:** It exists on a flat *surface* (the picture plane). While it can *create the illusion* of 3D depth (using perspective, chiaroscuro), the artwork itself is flat.
- **Items/Disciplines in 2D Art:**
 1. **Drawing:** (Pencil, charcoal, ink on paper).
 2. **Painting:** (Oil, acrylic, watercolour on canvas or paper).
 3. **Printmaking:** (Linocut, etching, Ukiyo-e)
 4. **Photography:** (A print or a digital image).
 5. **Graphic Design:** (Posters, logos, book covers).
 6. **Textiles (Surface):** *Adire* (dyeing), *Batik*, and textile *printing* are 2D.
 7. **Collage:** (Gluing flat items to a surface).

5.3 THREE-DIMENSIONAL (3D) ART

- **Definition:** An artwork that has **three (3)** dimensions: **Length, Width, and Depth (or Height)**.
- **Key Concept:** It occupies **real physical space**. You can walk *around* it (or in it). It has mass and volume.
- **Items/Disciplines in 3D Art:**
 1. **Sculpture:**
 - **In-the-Round:** Free-standing, can be viewed from all sides (e.g., a statue).
 - **Relief:** Attached to a background (e.g., a carved wall).

2. **Ceramics (Pottery):** (e.g., a pot, a vase).
3. **Architecture:** (e.g., a building - the ultimate 3D art).
4. **Fashion Design:** (e.g., a dress - it has form and exists in space).
5. **Furniture Design:** (e.g., a chair).
6. **Assemblage:** (A 3D sculpture made of found objects).
7. **Installation Art:** An artwork that transforms an entire *room* or *space*.

5.4 DIFFERENTIATION (2D vs. 3D)

Feature	TWO-DIMENSIONAL (2D)	THREE-DIMENSIONAL (3D)
Dimensions	Length, Width	Length, Width, Depth
Space	Exists on a flat surface.	Occupies real space.
Depth	Illusion of depth (using perspective).	Actual depth (has real volume).
Examples	Painting, Drawing, Photography.	Sculpture, Pottery, Architecture.
"Grey Area"	A Relief Sculpture is a hybrid. It's a 3D object <i>on</i> a 2D ground.	

EVALUATION

1. What are the two dimensions of 2D art?
2. What are the three dimensions of 3D art?
3. Is a photograph 2D or 3D? Why?
4. Is a clay pot 2D or 3D? Why?
5. What is the difference between "implied depth" (in 2D) and "actual depth" (in 3D)?

ASSIGNMENT

1. List three 2D art forms and three 3D art forms that were practiced in *traditional* Nigerian society. (e.g., 2D - Uli wall painting, 3D - Benin bronze head).

WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

This week is for the midterm break.



WEEK 8: CONTINUATION OF TWO- AND THREE-DIMENSIONAL ARTS (MIXED MEDIA)

8.1 ANALYSIS OF 2D AND 3D ART (ADVANCED)

In SS3, we move beyond simple definitions to see how artists *combine* 2D and 3D concepts.

- **2D art that *thinks* like 3D:** When a painter uses *impasto* (thick paint), the paint creates an *actual* 3D texture (a low relief) on the 2D canvas.
- **3D art that *thinks* like 2D:** When a sculptor (like **El Anatsui**) creates a massive, flexible "hanging" from 3D bottle-tops, but it is hung flat on a wall like a 2D tapestry.

8.2 EXPERIMENTING WITH MIXED MEDIA

Mixed Media is the use of *more than one* medium or material in a single artwork. This is a key technique in contemporary art.

A. 2D MIXED MEDIA

This involves working on a flat surface but incorporating multiple materials.

- **Collage:** The most famous 2D mixed media. Invented by Cubists (Picasso, Braque).
 - **Process:** Gluing materials like newspaper, fabric, photographs, and wallpaper onto a drawing or painting.
- **Photomontage:** A collage made specifically from photographs.
- **Wet + Dry Media:** Using "wet" media (like watercolour, ink) with "dry" media (like charcoal, pastel) on the same paper.

B. 3D MIXED MEDIA

This involves creating a 3D object using a variety of materials.

- **Assemblage:** The 3D version of collage. It is a sculpture made by joining (assembling) various "found objects."

- **Example:** A sculptor welding together scrap metal, car parts, and plastic bottles to create a figure.
- **Installation Art:** This is an extreme form of 3D mixed media. The artist uses *an entire room or space* as their "canvas," filling it with objects, light, sound, or video to create an immersive experience.
- **Contemporary Craft:** Many Nigerian craftspeople use mixed media (e.g., decorating a *calabash* (3D) with *beads* and *fabric*).

8.3 APPLYING KNOWLEDGE IN PRACTICAL WORK

The goal of mixed media is to use the *unique properties* of each material.

- Why just *paint* a picture of a newspaper when you can *glue* an actual newspaper to the canvas?
- Why try to *carve* the texture of a tin can from wood when you can just *use* a real tin can in your sculpture?
- **Key Artists:**
 - **Pablo Picasso (Cubism):** Pioneered collage (e.g., *Still Life with Chair Caning*).
 - **Robert Rauschenberg (Pop Art):** Famous for his "combines" (half-painting, half-sculpture).
 - **El Anatsui (Nigeria/Ghana):** Uses bottle-tops, copper wire, and wood.
 - **Bruce Onobrakpeya (Nigeria):** His "Plastograph" prints are mixed media, incorporating found objects and epoxy.

EVALUATION

1. Define "Mixed Media."
2. What is the difference between "Collage" and "Assemblage"?
3. Name one Nigerian artist who is famous for working in mixed media.
4. How can a painting (a 2D art form) have 3D properties?

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT

1. **Create a 2D Mixed Media Collage.**
2. **Theme:** "My Environment."
3. **Materials:** A piece of cardboard (as your base), glue, scissors.
4. **Find and use at least FOUR (4)** different materials: e.g., newspaper (for text), magazine photos (for images), fabric (for texture), leaves/sand (for natural texture), plastic (for man-made texture).
5. Arrange and glue these items to create a unified composition.



WEEK 9: PRACTICAL PROJECT WORK

9.1 INTRODUCTION

This week is dedicated to a supervised, self-directed project. The goal is to synthesize all the knowledge and skills you have learned (in SS1, SS2, and SS3) into a single, high-quality "examination-standard" artwork.

This project is a rehearsal for your SSCE (WAEC/NECO) practical exam.

9.2 PROJECT BRIEF: DEMONSTRATING CREATIVITY

You will choose ONE project from the following options, based on your area of strength and interest:

1. Project A: Imaginative Composition (2D)

- **Task:** Create a detailed, full-colour imaginative composition painting.
- **Theme (choose one):** "Election Day," "A Crowded Clinic," "The Day My Team Won," "My Local Festival."
- **Skills:** Composition (foreground/middle/background), perspective, human/figure drawing, colour theory, and paint application.

2. Project B: 3D Mixed Media Assemblage (3D)

- **Task:** Create a 3D sculpture using "found objects."
- **Theme (choose one):** "Urban Decay," "Technology," "A Spirit Figure."
- **Skills:** 3D form, balance, texture, and construction (joining different materials).

3. Project C: Applied Art / Craft (2D/3D)

- **Task:** Produce a high-quality "applied art" object based on Nigerian craft.
- **Examples:** A large, highly-detailed *Adire* (Batik/Tye-Dye) wall hanging; a *Plastograph* (low-relief print); a large, decorated ceramic pot.
- **Skills:** Craftsmanship, mastery of a specific technique, and original design.

9.3 PROJECT PROCESS

1. **Proposal & Sketches (Day 1):** Choose your project. Produce at least 3 thumbnail sketches and a final, detailed preparatory drawing. Get this *approved* by your teacher.
2. **Execution (Days 2-4):**
 - Gather your materials.
 - Begin the final artwork, following your sketch.
 - Focus on **craftsmanship, neatness, and finishing**.
 - Manage your time.
3. **Presentation (Day 5):**
 - The project must be "finished" (e.g., paintings must be "window-mounted" on cardboard; sculptures must be stable and clean).
 - You will present your work to the class.

9.4 PRESENTATION AND DEFENSE (CRITIQUE)

When you present, you must be prepared to "defend" your work using the correct **art terminologies** (from Week 4). Be ready to answer:

- "What was your objective?"
- "Why did you choose this composition?"
- "What is your focal point, and how did you create it?"
- "What challenges did you face, and how did you solve them?"
- "How does this piece communicate your chosen theme?"

EVALUATION

- This week is entirely practical. Evaluation will be based on:
 1. **Creativity & Originality:** (15%)
 2. **Composition & Design:** (25%)
 3. **Skill & Technique (Craftsmanship):** (30%)
 4. **Finishing & Presentation:** (15%)
 5. **Verbal Defence/Critique:** (15%)

WEEK 10: APPRECIATION OF NIGERIAN CRAFTS AND ARTS

10.1 VALUING INDIGENOUS CRAFTS AND ARTS

To "appreciate" art is to understand its value. The indigenous (traditional) arts and crafts of Nigeria are "priceless" because they are:

- **Our Identity:** They are a unique and tangible record of our ancestors' beliefs, philosophies, and daily lives.
- **Our History:** They are "history books" (e.g., the Benin plaques record the history of the Oba's court).
- **A Library of Skill:** They represent thousands of years of human innovation and mastery over materials (e.g., Adire, Lost-Wax casting).
- **A Source of Inspiration:** They are the "artistic DNA" for all contemporary Nigerian art.

10.2 PRESERVATION OF NIGERIAN CRAFTS

Many Nigerian crafts are **endangered** and at risk of disappearing.

- **Threats:**
 - **Globalization:** Cheap, mass-produced plastic and imported goods (e.g., a plastic bowl is cheaper than a hand-made pot).
 - **Changing Tastes:** Younger generations may see crafts as "old-fashioned."
 - **Loss of Knowledge:** When an old master-craftsman dies without an apprentice, the knowledge is lost forever.
- **Methods of Preservation:**
 1. **Documentation:** Museums, scholars, and artists must photograph, film, and write about these craft processes.
 2. **Education:** Teaching crafts in schools (like this class) and universities to give them status.
 3. **Museums:** Acquiring and protecting the "masterpieces" of the past (e.g., The National Museum, Lagos).

4. **Adaptation & Innovation (The Best Method):** Craftspeople must *adapt* their traditional skills to create *new* products for a *modern* market. (e.g., using Adire patterns on high-fashion dresses, sneakers, or laptop bags).
5. **Patronage:** We must *buy* and *use* locally-made crafts to keep the craftspeople in business.

10.3 INFLUENCE OF TRADITIONAL CRAFTS ON CONTEMPORARY NIGERIAN ARTS

This is the *most important* theme in modern Nigerian art history. Contemporary artists are *not* in competition with crafts; they are *inspired* by them.

This influence is the core of the "**Natural Synthesis**" philosophy (from the Zaria Art Society).

- **Uche Okeke (Painter):** Took the fluid lines and abstract symbols from **Igbo Uli** (a female body/wall painting craft) and used them as the basis for his modern paintings and drawings.
- **Bruce Onobrakpeya (Printmaker):** Drew inspiration from **Urhobo carving, folklore, and mythology**. He even invented his "Plastograph" technique to mimic the low-relief feel of a carved door.
- **Ladi Kwali (Potter):** She was a *literal* bridge. She was a traditional Gwari potter (a craftswoman) who was "discovered" and began working in a modern studio (as an "artist"), blending her traditional coiling and incising techniques with modern glazes and a potter's wheel.
- **El Anatsui (Sculptor):** Inspired by the patterns and "fluidity" of **Kente cloth** (a craft), he created his monumental, flexible sculptures from "waste" materials (bottle-tops).

EVALUATION

1. Give two reasons why we should value and preserve indigenous Nigerian crafts.
2. List three (3) major threats to the survival of traditional crafts.
3. What is the *best* way to preserve a craft tradition?
4. Explain "Natural Synthesis."

5. Give a *specific* example of a contemporary artist and the *specific* craft that influenced them.

ASSIGNMENT

1. Visit a local market (or look online) for a traditional craft (e.g., a woven mat, a calabash, a leather puff). Write a short "appreciation" (1-2 paragraphs) about it. Discuss its materials, its (likely) function, and the skill you think was involved in making it.



WEEK 11: REVISION

- **General Review:** This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered this term, with a strong focus on preparing for the SSCE (WAEC/NECO) examinations.
- **Key Exam Focus Areas:**
 - **Theory (Paper 1):**
 - Distinguishing Fine vs. Applied Art (Week 1).
 - Knowing the Nigerian "Craft Map" (Week 3).
 - Mastering ALL Art Terminologies (Weeks 4 & 5).
 - Understanding the influence of crafts on artists (e.g., Uli, Ladi Kwali) (Week 10).
 - **Practical (Paper 2 & 3):**
 - Imaginative Composition: Your ability to draw from imagination, using foreground, middle ground, and background (Week 2).
 - General Drawing / Still Life: Your ability to observe and record (revisiting earlier terms).
 - Crafts: Your mastery of a specific craft (e.g., Adire, Pottery).